ATLANTIC CITY
COMMUNITY COOPERATIVE

Powered by People, Built for Community

PROJECT BRIEF | JULY 2026

City Owned. City Built. City Powered.

A full-service supermarket, Boardwalk Basket digital marketplace, social impact center, health concierge network, workforce pathways, and neighborhood engagement system — organized through community ownership.

A community-owned implementation platform for Atlantic City shared prosperity, putting the 2018 Shared Prosperity Report and the 2021 Restart & Recovery Working Group recommendations into operation.

FOOD | HEALTH | WORK | BUSINESS | OWN

12
BLOCK CAPTAINS AT LAUNCH

48
NEIGHBORHOOD BLOCKS COVERED

5,000
MEMBERS TARGETED BY END OF 2026

Prepared for residents, public agencies, funders, healthcare systems, employers, anchor institutions, businesses, and implementation partners.

July 2026

www.accoop.com



Executive Brief

Atlantic City has already identified the major ingredients of shared prosperity. The 2018 report, *Atlantic City: Building a Foundation for Shared Prosperity*, and the 2021 Atlantic City Restart & Recovery Working Group report call for coordinated implementation across food access, workforce development, economic diversification, public health, youth opportunity, small-business growth, community engagement, and accountable partnerships.

The challenge is not a lack of programs. The challenge is that residents, small businesses, service providers, employers, and public institutions often operate through separate systems. Atlantic City Community Cooperative is designed to become the resident-facing operating platform that connects those systems and turns recommendations into completed transactions, delivered groceries, jobs, referrals, business sales, preventive-care connections, and measurable neighborhood outcomes.

THE CENTRAL PROPOSITION

Atlantic City Community Cooperative is not another isolated program. It is community wealth infrastructure: one membership, one trusted access point, and multiple pathways to food, health, employment, entrepreneurship, services, and ownership.

Why Atlantic City Community Cooperative is a strong implementation fit

- It directly advances the 2018 report's recommendation for a citizen-run food co-op and a high-quality food market as a catalytic community amenity.
- It operationalizes the repeated 2021 recommendations for one point of contact, resource mapping, community collaboration databases, coordinated referrals, and stronger public awareness.
- It connects workforce training to real operating enterprises, paid work-based learning, Block Captain employment, delivery logistics, vendor services, and local hiring.
- It creates a local digital marketplace - Boardwalk Basket - that expands market access for Atlantic City businesses while meeting the daily needs of residents, workers, and visitors.
- It gives residents a formal role as members and owners, creating a durable mechanism for community voice, local accountability, and wealth retention.

IMMEDIATE STAKEHOLDER DECISION

Stakeholders should treat ACCOOP as a community implementation partner and cooperative anchor intermediary. Public, philanthropic, healthcare, employer, and institutional partners can use the platform to reach residents, coordinate programs, buy locally, sponsor access, create jobs, and measure outcomes - while retaining clear responsibility for their own specialized services.

What the Two Reports Require

Although written in different contexts, the two reports converge on the same operational conclusion: Atlantic City needs a comprehensive, resident-centered system that coordinates existing assets and expands local ownership.

One city, one shared vision

A coordinated platform rather than disconnected projects and short-term initiatives.

High-quality food access

A full-service market, affordable fresh food, delivery, nutrition support, and food-desert elimination.

Workforce pathways

One point of contact, employer alignment, youth pathways, re-skilling, and support for residents facing barriers.

Economic diversification

Support for small and minority-owned businesses, entrepreneurship, digital market access, local procurement, and emerging sectors.

Public health coordination

Resource mapping, preventive engagement, health education, provider partnerships, and referral follow-through.

Community outreach

A maintained collaboration database, trusted messengers, neighborhood engagement, and better awareness of existing programs.

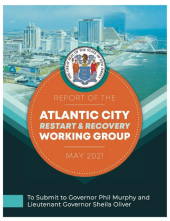
Youth & civic participation

Internships, summer employment, mentorship, civic associations, leadership, recreation, and pathways to growing careers.

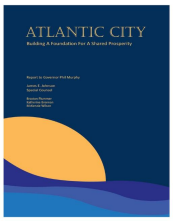
Anchor partnerships

Clear implementation ownership, sustained cross-sector agreements, data, performance standards, and transparent reporting.

Sources: *Atlantic City: Building a Foundation for Shared Prosperity* (2018), pp. 1–3, 21, 31–38; *Report of the Atlantic City Restart & Recovery Working Group* (2021), pp. 5–6, 12–30.



DOWNLOAD THE REPORT



DOWNLOAD THE REPORT

One Platform

The ACCOOP Implementation Framework

The Atlantic City Community Cooperative (ACCOOP) brings together a wide range of community services through a unified membership system, shared technology, a central physical location, neighborhood engagement, and measurable partner processes. Rather than replacing the expertise of existing organizations, the platform is designed to make services easier to discover, access, coordinate, and evaluate.

ONE MEMBERSHIP. ONE TRUSTED ACCESS POINT. MULTIPLE OPPORTUNITIES.

Food Access

Community market, Boardwalk Basket, delivery, local sourcing.

Social Impact Center

One intake, resource mapping, referrals, Individual Empowerment Plan.

Small Business

Vendor marketplace, delivery reach, entrepreneurship support.

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Atlantic City Community Cooperative

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Health & Wellness

Preferred provider network, navigation, prevention and outreach.

Workforce & Youth

Paid work-based learning, Block Captains, job pathways.

Data + Governance

Membership, accountability, outcomes, community voice.

Core Operating Components

Rather than a single program, ACCOOP operates a coordinated portfolio of eight core components.

1. Community Membership & Ownership

Residents, workers, businesses, and supporters enter through clear membership pathways. Community-owner members gain a structured voice in the Co-op's direction, while patron and access members receive services and benefits appropriate to their participation.

2. Community Supermarket & Food Hub

A full-service physical and digital food operation improves access to fresh, affordable food, supports benefit use subject to approval, creates local jobs, and provides a platform for nutrition, local sourcing, and community programming.

3. Boardwalk Basket

Atlantic City's digital marketplace and delivery network connects groceries, restaurants, retail, home services, health essentials, professional services, local vendors, and visitor-facing offerings through one local platform.

4. Center for Social Impact

A single-intake and navigation model conducts barrier, financial, education, and employment assessments; builds an Individual Empowerment Plan; connects members to benefits and services; and tracks referral completion.

5. Health Concierge Network

A preferred provider and wellness network helps members understand options, connect to preventive and specialty care, access discounted or sponsored services where permissible, and reduce missed connections between health and social needs.

6. Workforce, Youth & Block Captains

Paid work-based learning, neighborhood outreach, digital assistance, delivery, vendor support, and employer pathways create visible entry points for Atlantic City youth, returning citizens, and residents seeking advancement.

7. Local Business & Vendor Ecosystem

Vendor onboarding, digital storefronts, delivery, promotion, technical assistance, institutional procurement opportunities, and customer data help local enterprises grow and retain more spending in Atlantic City.

8. Data, Governance & Accountability

Consent-based member records, verified resource directories, referral workflows, performance dashboards, member governance, partner agreements, and annual impact reporting provide the operating discipline required for credibility.

Membership and Community Ownership

The reports call for citizen engagement and stronger civic infrastructure. ACCOOP converts those goals into a practical membership system. Residents are not treated only as clients or consumers; they can become participants, owners, workers, vendors, volunteers, and decision-makers.

MEMBERSHIP PATHWAY	PRIMARY AUDIENCE	ROLE IN THE MODEL
Join Free - Patron Member	Residents, workers, visitors, and supporters.	Access marketplace, communications, events, and general member opportunities.
Get Support - Premium Access Member	Eligible residents seeking coordinated assistance.	Single intake, navigation, priority access to support pathways, and sponsored benefits where available.
Own the Movement - Community Owner Member	Eligible Atlantic City residents, workers, and local businesses.	Voting and ownership rights as defined by governing documents, participation in member decisions, and community economic benefits.
Invest in Atlantic City - Corporate/Sponsor Member	Businesses, institutions, employers, foundations, and civic partners.	Non-voting sponsorship and partnership pathways tied to defined community outcomes.

Community accountability mechanisms

- Member assemblies and listening sessions
- Neighborhood-level outreach and feedback through Block Captains
- Published operating and impact dashboards
- Clear bylaws, board policies, conflict-of-interest controls, and delegated authority
- Transparent reporting on member participation, local purchasing, jobs, referrals, and financial sustainability

Boardwalk Basket: Atlantic City's Digital Marketplace

Boardwalk Basket supports the reports' economic-diversification and small-business goals by turning Atlantic City demand into a searchable local marketplace. It also provides the operating channel through which the Co-op can create delivery jobs, integrate benefit access where approved, promote local vendors, and collect aggregate data on unmet demand.



A New Way to Shop AC

- Groceries and fresh food
- Local restaurant delivery
- Retail and everyday essentials
- Home, automotive, beauty, wellness, pharmacy, and professional services
- Local hotel and visitor offerings
- Vendor promotion and delivery logistics

Why Atlantic City Community Cooperative is a strong implementation fit

STEP	MEMBER OR VENDOR EXPERIENCE	IMPLEMENTATION RESULT
Onboard	Member creates an account; vendor completes verification and catalog setup.	Trusted participation and defined service standards.
Discover	Users search local products, services, jobs, benefits, and events.	Improved awareness and reduced fragmentation.
Transact or request	Member places an order or requests assistance.	Demand becomes an actionable workflow.
Fulfill	Vendor, driver, navigator, or partner completes the service.	Local revenue, employment, delivery, or referral completion.
Measure	Platform records completion, timing, satisfaction, and unresolved needs.	Accountability and continuous improvement.

Social Impact and Health Navigation

The 2021 report repeatedly recommends resource mapping, coordination, one point of contact, improved awareness, and follow-through. ACCOOP implements those recommendations through a combined Center for Social Impact and Health Concierge Network.

Center for Social Impact Workflow

STAGE	OPERATING ACTION	OUTPUT
Intake	Confirm membership, consent, immediate needs, household priorities, and preferred communication.	Member profile and urgent-needs triage.
Assessment	Complete financial, barrier, academic, employment, digital-access, housing, transportation, and benefit screening.	Structured needs and strengths assessment.
Plan	Create an Individual Empowerment Plan with priorities, responsibilities, and milestones.	Member-owned action plan.
Match	Use a verified partner directory to route the member to qualified providers and opportunities.	Referral, appointment, application, or enrollment.
Close the loop	Confirm whether the connection was completed and identify remaining barriers.	Completed referral or escalation.
Report	Aggregate outcomes by service, neighborhood, and population while protecting privacy.	Gap analysis and partner performance dashboard.

Health Concierge Network

- Preferred provider relationships covering primary care, behavioral health, dental, vision, pharmacy, maternal health, disability, aging, wellness, and social determinants of health.
- Member education and navigation for Medicaid, Medicare, employer coverage, uninsured options, and community resources - without replacing licensed clinical or insurance professionals.
- Preventive-care outreach, appointment assistance, transportation coordination, follow-up, and connection to food, housing, employment, and benefit supports.
- Partner sponsorships, navigation contracts, and value-based arrangements only where legally permissible and professionally reviewed.

Workforce, Youth and Neighborhood Implementation

Both reports emphasize that Atlantic City must build people - particularly youth - while connecting training to employers and growing sectors. ACCOOP embeds workforce development inside real operating businesses and community outreach.

Block Captain Program

The Block Captain model creates a paid, neighborhood-based implementation workforce. Initial deployment can use **12 captains serving Atlantic City's 48 blocks**, with each captain responsible for four blocks and supported by centralized supervision, training, technology, and performance goals.

FUNCTION	BLOCK CAPTAIN ACTIVITY	REPORT RECOMMENDATION ADVANCED
Community outreach	Door-to-door and event outreach, member enrollment, multilingual awareness, feedback collection.	Civic participation, program awareness, neighborhood engagement.
Digital inclusion	Help members use Boardwalk Basket, access online resources, and complete forms.	Digital divide reduction and one-point-of-contact access.
Food access	Support ordering, delivery, benefit-use education, and senior/disabled access.	Food-desert response and equitable access.
Workforce navigation	Promote training, jobs, internships, and employer opportunities.	Youth pathways, re-skilling, and employer alignment.
Referral support	Help members connect to the Social Impact Center and follow up on unresolved barriers.	Resource mapping, coordinated referrals, and awareness.
Local business growth	Recruit and support vendors, collect business needs, and promote local purchasing.	Small-business support and economic diversification.

Paid pathways connected to operations

- Delivery and fulfillment
- Customer and member service
- Food retail and inventory
- Digital marketplace administration
- Community outreach and data collection
- Vendor success and entrepreneurship support
- Health and social-service navigation support
- Technology, media, and community communications

2018 Shared Prosperity Recommendations in Operation

Each recommendation from *Atlantic City: Building a Foundation for Shared Prosperity* (2018) maps to a specific, already-designed ACCOOP function.

2018 RECOMMENDATION	ACCOOP OPERATIONAL RESPONSE	OPERATING HOME
One city with one shared vision	Use common membership, shared partner standards, integrated service channels, a public impact framework, and a recognizable community-owned brand.	Platform-wide governance, membership, communications, dashboard
Avoid a single "silver bullet" project	Operate a coordinated portfolio linking food, jobs, health, business, youth, services, and ownership.	Multi-service hub with phased business units
High-quality food as a community amenity	Open a full-service community supermarket and digital food platform with delivery and local sourcing.	Community market, Boardwalk Basket, food hub
Citizen-run food co-op as a catalytic project	Create community-owner membership and resident participation in governance and economic benefits.	Ownership structure and member assemblies
Economic diversification and higher-wage pathways	Use the marketplace and hub to support non-casino businesses, entrepreneurship, technology, logistics, health, construction, food, and visitor services.	Vendor ecosystem, WBL, procurement, business services
Institutional home for a Jobs Council	Convene employers, training providers, workforce agencies, and community partners around a shared opportunity directory and placement metrics.	Workforce partner council and data platform
Career pathways beginning in high school	Offer youth employment, internships, Block Captains, paid WBL, mentorship, and employer transitions.	Youth and workforce operations
Support residents with barriers to employment	Combine navigation, supportive services, paid experience, digital access, and employer partnerships.	Social Impact Center plus WBL
Support small and minority-owned businesses	Provide digital storefronts, delivery, customer acquisition, technical assistance, and local procurement connections.	Boardwalk Basket and vendor success
Create a community collaboration database	Maintain a verified directory of services, providers, opportunities, events, and referral pathways.	Shared resource platform and closed-loop referrals
Strengthen civic associations and citizen-led organizations	Use member meetings, Block Captains, neighborhood listening sessions, volunteer roles, and community programming.	Community engagement system
Coordinate anchor institutions	Execute MOUs, contracts, sponsorships, procurement commitments, shared outcomes, and data agreements.	Anchor partnership framework

2021 Restart & Recovery Recommendations in Operation

Each recommendation from the *Report of the Atlantic City Restart & Recovery Working Group* (2021) maps to a specific, already-designed ACCOOP function.

2021 RECOMMENDATION	ACCOOP OPERATIONAL RESPONSE	OPERATING HOME
One entity as a point of contact	Create a member service desk, navigators, case routing, escalation standards, and follow-up.	Center for Social Impact
Up-skill and re-skill residents	Connect assessments, training, paid WBL, credentials, employer referrals, and wage progression.	Workforce network and operating enterprises
Support chronically underemployed residents, youth, and returning citizens	Use paid entry roles, barrier reduction, coaching, and second-chance employer partnerships.	Block Captains, delivery, retail, WBL
Create jobs and development databases	Maintain live listings for jobs, training, internships, business resources, and partner services.	Digital platform and partner portal
Link workforce training to emerging and non-tourism sectors	Build pathways in health, logistics, construction, technology, food systems, clean energy, and professional services.	Employer-aligned pathway portfolio
Provide a concierge approach for businesses	Offer vendor onboarding, marketplace access, technical assistance, referrals, promotion, and procurement navigation.	Vendor Success Center
Map public-health resources and gaps	Maintain verified provider profiles, eligibility information, language access, capacity, and referral outcomes.	Health Concierge Network
Coordinate mental health, substance-use, homelessness, and at-risk services	Use consent-based routing, warm handoffs, escalation, and closed-loop follow-up with specialized partners.	Social Impact and health navigation
Eliminate the food desert	Provide affordable food, digital ordering, neighborhood delivery, benefit access subject to approval, and local sourcing.	Community market and Boardwalk Basket
Provide health education on affordable healthy eating and activity	Integrate nutrition education, recipes, screenings, wellness partners, and member communications.	Health Concierge Network
Make residents aware of available programs	Deploy Block Captains, multilingual communications, member alerts, events, and a searchable resource directory.	Neighborhood outreach and platform
Create a community collaboration database maintained by an anchor	Operate a durable platform under formal anchor agreements, data standards, and shared accountability.	ACCOOP as cooperative anchor intermediary
Expand youth employment and internships	Create paid Block Captain, delivery, retail, technology, outreach, and partner placement roles.	Youth employment system
Strengthen community events and neighborhood life	Use the hub, marketplace, member calendar, local vendors, and public programming to activate community life.	Community hub and events

Governance and Partnership Architecture

The reports call for collaboration, but collaboration without decision rights, service standards, and data responsibilities can reproduce the same fragmentation. ACCOOP therefore requires a layered governance model.

LAYER	PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY	REQUIRED CONTROLS
Board governance	Mission, fiduciary oversight, risk, strategy, executive accountability, and protection of community purpose.	Bylaws, conflicts policy, delegated authority, audits, dashboards.
Member governance	Community voice, elections or voting where applicable, member priorities, and feedback.	Eligibility rules, notice, voting procedures, grievance process.
Management	Daily operations, staffing, unit economics, quality, compliance, and partner execution.	Budgets, SOPs, KPIs, procurement, HR, data security.
Partner governance	Service delivery, referral response, purchasing, sponsorship, workforce placements, and shared outcomes.	MOUs, SLAs, data agreements, escalation, attribution.
Community accountability	Neighborhood equity, accessibility, transparency, and responsiveness.	Public impact reporting, listening sessions, equity audits.

Who Does What

- **Government:** align programs, contracts, public information, referrals, approvals, procurement, and performance expectations.
- **Healthcare:** build provider access, preventive-care campaigns, navigation support, data-safe referrals, and community benefit investment.
- **Employers:** offer jobs, paid work-based learning, advancement pathways, procurement, and skill validation.
- **Foundations and sponsors:** capitalize launch functions, underwrite access, fund evaluation, and support scale after milestones are met.
- **Anchor institutions:** provide implementation leadership, evaluation, technical assistance, facilities, talent, procurement, and sustained data stewardship.
- **Community organizations:** retain specialized service roles while using ACCOOP to improve reach, referral completion, and visibility.
- **Residents and members:** shape priorities, use services, buy locally, provide feedback, volunteer, work, sell, and govern.

Phased Implementation Roadmap

PHASE	TIMING	PRIORITY OPERATING WORK	DECISION GATE
1. Mobilize and prove access	0-6 months	Build membership; stabilize Boardwalk Basket; onboard priority vendors and providers; deploy Block Captains; publish verified resource directory; finalize privacy and partner standards.	Active users, reliable fulfillment, partner response, neighborhood reach.
2. Close the loop	6-12 months	Launch single intake and Individual Empowerment Plans; pilot Health Concierge workflows; track completed referrals; expand paid WBL and employer partnerships.	Referral closure, member retention, cost per outcome, partner quality.
3. Activate the physical hub	12-24 months	Open market and hub functions in phases; expand local sourcing and benefit access subject to approvals; integrate programs, events, and procurement.	Store economics, food affordability, foot traffic, local sales, safety.
4. Institutionalize and scale	24+ months	Secure multi-year contracts; publish annual impact accounts; formalize member governance cycles; replicate proven workflows and partnerships.	Financial sustainability, verified outcomes, governance maturity.

BOARDWALK BASKET

Atlantic City's own marketplace

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Outcomes and Performance Framework

The Co-op's value will be judged by verified use and outcomes - not only enrollment, events, or platform registrations. Reporting will distinguish outputs, completed outcomes, financial sustainability, and neighborhood equity.

DOMAIN	OPERATIONAL REQUIREMENT
Membership and ownership	Total and active members; owner participation; retention; voting or meeting participation; neighborhood reach; satisfaction.
Food access	Households purchasing; fresh-food share; affordability; orders; deliveries; on-time rate; benefit transactions when approved; senior and disabled access.
Local business	Active vendors; vendor sales; repeat customers; minority/women-owned participation; local procurement; vendor retention and satisfaction.
Workforce and youth	Paid participants; hours; credentials; placements; retention; wage progression; employer satisfaction; youth and returning-citizen participation.
Health and social care	Members screened; referrals issued; referral completion; time to service; preventive-care connections; benefit enrollment; unresolved barriers.
Neighborhood outreach	Block coverage; contacts; enrollments; assistance completed; events; language access; resident issues resolved.
Platform performance	Order fulfillment; delivery time; system uptime; data quality; privacy incidents; partner response; referral closure.
Financial sustainability	Revenue by unit; gross margin; cost per member and outcome; unrestricted cash; working capital; grant dependency; sponsor renewal.
Shared prosperity	Household savings; earned income; local dollars retained; member economic benefits; resident perception of opportunity and access.

ILLUSTRATIVE NEAR-TERM OPERATING TARGETS

- Reach and activate **5,000 members** by end of 2026
- Build a verified network of food vendors, service providers, employers, health partners, and community organizations
- Provide full neighborhood coverage through the Block Captain model
- Establish baseline data for food access, household barriers, local purchasing, service awareness, and referral completion
- Publish a first annual community impact account with audited or independently validated measures where feasible

Outcomes and Performance Framework

A durable community platform cannot depend on a single grant or narrow retail margin. ACCOOP should use a blended model in which commercial revenue supports core operations while public and philanthropic funds pay for measurable public-benefit functions.

REVENUE/SUPPORT LINE	MECHANISM	PUBLIC-BENEFIT FUNCTION SUPPORTED
Community market	Retail margin on food and household essentials.	Food-access infrastructure, jobs, and local purchasing.
Boardwalk Basket	Commissions, delivery fees, service fees, vendor services, and promotional options.	Technology, fulfillment, delivery jobs, and local market access.
Membership and sponsorship	Member capital where applicable, institutional memberships, sponsorships, and campaign support.	Member services, outreach, launch capitalization, and access subsidies.
Social Impact Center	Government contracts, grants, philanthropy, and partner contributions.	Intake, benefits navigation, barrier reduction, and closed-loop referrals.
Health Concierge Network	Navigation contracts, community-benefit support, sponsorships, and permissible provider arrangements.	Preventive outreach, care navigation, and health-social coordination.
Workforce and Block Captains	Workforce grants, employer contracts, service revenue, and sponsorships.	Paid WBL, neighborhood employment, and employer pathways.
Facility and programming	Rentals, events, training, community kitchen, vendor services, and program fees.	Hub operations, community activity, and entrepreneurship.

Each business unit have separate unit economics, contribution-margin targets, cash requirements, and scale gates. Public-benefit work will be funded through explicit contracts or restricted support rather than hidden inside retail losses.
FINANCIAL PRINCIPLE

Key Risks and Required Safeguards

Scope overload

Risk: Launching food, delivery, navigation, health, workforce, and governance at once can reduce quality.
Safeguard: Phased launches, minimum viable workflows, named owners, and stop/go gates.

Member inactivity

Risk: Registration may not become purchasing, ownership participation, or completed assistance.
Safeguard: Activation campaigns, Block Captains, clear benefits, retention metrics.

Financial fragility

Risk: Food and delivery margins are narrow; navigation is labor intensive.
Safeguard: Unit economics, working-capital thresholds, blended funding, scale discipline.

Data privacy

Risk: Health, benefits, employment, and household data create legal and trust exposure.
Safeguard: Minimum necessary data, informed consent, role access, legal review, incident response.

Partner resistance or duplication

Risk: Organizations may perceive competition or administrative burden.
Safeguard: Co-design workflows, attribute outcomes, preserve specialist roles, reduce duplicate intake.

Governance ambiguity

Risk: Member, board, founder, partner, and management roles can overlap.
Safeguard: Clear bylaws, policies, delegated authority, conflicts controls, transparent reporting.

Uneven neighborhood benefit

Risk: Easier-to-reach residents may receive disproportionate value.
Safeguard: Block-level targets, language access, equity audits, targeted outreach.

Regulatory noncompliance

Risk: Food, benefits, healthcare, labor, investment, and data functions involve distinct rules.
Safeguard: Qualified legal, accounting, food-safety, insurance, and compliance review before launch.

10 Reasons Why a Community Co-op Is Essential for Atlantic City

Addressing Food Insecurity

Atlantic City is a food desert, and a community co-op ensures fresh, healthy, and affordable food access for all residents.

Empowering the Local Economy

A co-op model keeps money circulating within the community, supporting small businesses and local farmers.

Creating Sustainable Jobs

The co-op will provide employment and entrepreneurial opportunities for residents, reducing unemployment.

Supporting Local Farmers & Producers

By prioritizing local sourcing, the co-op helps farmers and small vendors thrive, promoting food sustainability.

Affordable, High-Quality Goods

Community co-ops operate on a non-profit basis, keeping prices fair and quality high for everyday essentials.

Strengthening Community Bonds

A co-op is more than a grocery store; it's a space where residents can connect, learn, and support each other.

Encouraging Healthier Lifestyles

With fresh, organic, and locally sourced food, the co-op helps fight diet-related illnesses and promotes well-being.

Environmental Sustainability

The co-op model reduces waste, promotes eco-friendly practices, and introduces innovative solutions like urban farming.

Youth & Workforce Development

Through training and skill-building initiatives, the co-op creates pathways to careers in retail, farming, and business.

Community Resilience & Self-Reliance

Owning a cooperative strengthens the city's ability to withstand economic challenges and fosters long-term growth.

Stakeholder Action Agenda

STAKEHOLDER	WHY IT MATTERS
Residents and workers	Join, use the platform, become a community owner if eligible, attend meetings, provide feedback, buy locally, and refer neighbors.
Local businesses and vendors	Create a storefront, use delivery, participate in promotions, hire locally, offer member benefits, and report business outcomes.
Government and public agencies	Recognize ACCOOP as an implementation partner; align referrals, contracts, public information, procurement, and outcome reporting.
Healthcare systems and providers	Join the preferred network, support navigation and preventive outreach, sponsor access, and establish safe referral workflows.
Employers and casinos	Post jobs, offer paid WBL, procure locally, sponsor membership and transportation, and validate training pathways.
Schools and colleges	Connect students to internships, co-design pathways, provide faculty and evaluation support, and use the platform for outreach.
Foundations and corporations	Fund launch milestones, working capital, technology, Block Captains, evaluation, and access for high-barrier households.
Community organizations	List verified services, accept warm referrals, share outcome status, co-host outreach, and identify service gaps.
Anchor institutions	Commit multi-year leadership, data stewardship, procurement, technical support, and public accountability.

The Case for Collective Implementation

Atlantic City's reports already provide a coherent policy direction. They call for shared vision, food access, economic diversification, workforce pathways, youth investment, public-health coordination, community outreach, resource mapping, civic participation, and accountable anchor partnerships.

ACCOOP provides a credible structure for putting those recommendations into operation because it meets people where daily life occurs: shopping, work, health, transportation, digital access, neighborhood relationships, small-business transactions, and the need for trusted guidance. Its cooperative structure adds something conventional programs cannot provide on their own - resident ownership and a mechanism for retaining value in the community.

THE IMPLEMENTATION PROMISE

Own the problem. Build the solution. Change the narrative. Atlantic City Community Cooperative can become the connective tissue that turns fragmented assets into shared prosperity - powered by people and built for community.

References, Sources, and Reading Note

- *Atlantic City: Building a Foundation for Shared Prosperity.* Report prepared for Governor Phil Murphy, 2018.
- *Report of the Atlantic City Restart & Recovery Working Group*, May 2021.
- Atlantic City Community Cooperative website, accoop.com, reviewed July 2026.
- Atlantic City Community Cooperative concept materials and food co-op survey (638 responses).

Reading Note

This project brief is a strategic implementation and stakeholder-alignment document. It is not legal, financial, medical, tax, regulatory, or investment advice. Specific ownership terms, benefit acceptance, healthcare arrangements, data sharing, employment practices, fundraising, and regulated operations require review by qualified professionals and the appropriate public authorities before implementation.

We Believe You Belong

The Ideal Community Co-op is more than a project—it's a movement to reshape Atlantic City into a sustainable, opportunity-driven model city.

Join the Movement

Invest in the Co-op
Opportunities for funders & grant supporters.

Partner with Us
Collaborate as a supplier, small business, or nonprofit.

Become a Volunteer or Block Captain
Help drive impact in your neighborhood.

Follow Our Progress
Stay updated via our website and social media.



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